Washing Machine



Category: **Hospitality & Housekeeping** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Washing Machine

What it is used for

A washing machine cleans textiles by using water, detergent, and mechanical movement in a controlled wash cycle. Correct loading, program selection, and maintenance help improve cleaning results and protect fabrics and equipment.

Main parts

- Wash drum and outer tub
- Detergent and fabric conditioner dispenser
- Water inlet hose and inlet valve
- Drain hose and drain pump
- Program selector and control panel
- Door or lid lock and electrical power connection

Before you start

1. Read the operating instructions and check the machine's rated load capacity.
2. Inspect the power cable, water hoses, door seal, and drain connection for damage or leakage.
3. Separate laundry by colour, fabric type, and care-label instructions.
4. Empty pockets and remove loose objects, pins, and items that could damage the drum.
5. Use the recommended detergent type and quantity for the load and water conditions.
6. Ensure the machine is level, the drain is clear, and the water supply is available.

How to use

1. Load laundry evenly without exceeding the rated capacity.
2. Add detergent and fabric conditioner to the designated compartments as required.
3. Close the door or lid securely and confirm the locking mechanism engages.
4. Select the appropriate wash program, water temperature, and spin speed for the fabric.
5. Start the cycle and check that water enters and the drum operates normally.
6. Monitor the machine for unusual noise, excessive vibration, leaks, or error indicators.
7. Allow the complete wash and spin cycle to finish before opening the door.
8. Remove the laundry promptly and check that no items remain inside the drum.
9. Clean the detergent dispenser and accessible lint or debris filters according to the instructions.
10. Switch off the machine and leave the door slightly open when appropriate to allow drying.

⚠ Safety

- Keep hands away from the drum while it is moving or spinning.
- Do not operate the machine with damaged cables, leaking hoses, or a faulty door lock.
- Keep the floor around the machine dry to reduce slip and electric-shock risks.
- Do not exceed the rated load or climb on the machine.
- Disconnect power and close the water supply before maintenance or hose replacement.
- Use only approved detergents and never mix cleaning chemicals unless the product instructions explicitly permit it.

Care & storage

- Clean the detergent dispenser, door seal, and drum regularly.
- Inspect inlet and drain hoses for cracks, bulges, blockages, or leaks.
- Clean filters and perform the recommended drum-cleaning cycle at the specified interval.
- Keep the exterior dry and record faults or maintenance as required.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Overloading the drum can cause poor washing and excessive vibration.
- Using too much detergent can leave residue and create excessive foam.
- Selecting an unsuitable temperature or spin speed can damage delicate fabrics.
- Ignoring blocked filters or leaking hoses can cause drainage problems and water damage.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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